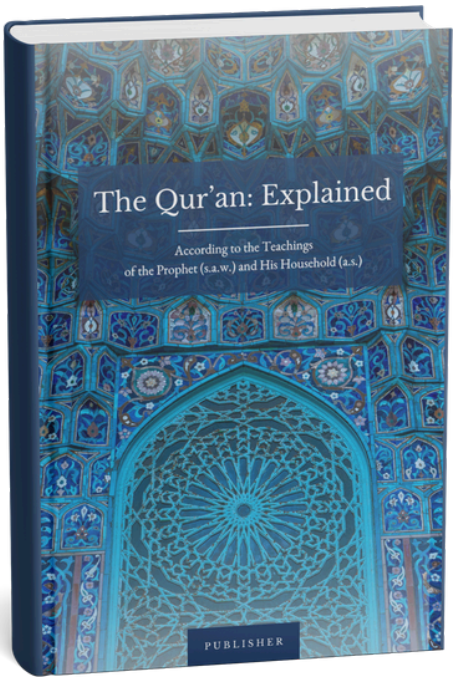
The Qur'an: Explained

An accessible one-volume commentary on the whole Qur'an based on the teachings of the Prophet (s.a.w.) and his Household (a.s.)

Our Challenge

- **No comprehensive and accessible** *tafsir* based on the Ahulbayt's (a.s.) teachings exists in English.
- **200,000+ UK Shi'a Muslims** (millions globally) lack resources reflecting their theological perspective.
- **Educational institutions** are forced to rely on together incomplete materials.
- **Generational disconnect:** Young English-speaking Shi'a Muslims cut off from reliable scholarship.
- **Spiritual danger:** Youth are exposed to different ideologies; need intellectual tools to support their faith.



Key Features

- Comprehensive commentary on the Qur'an in a single volume.
- Grounded in the teachings of the Prophet (s.a.w.) and Ahlulbayt (a.s.).
- Addresses critical gap in English-language scholarship.
- Written in clear English, suitable for youth.
- Unique Arabic-English design.

1 Page of the Qur'an = 1 Page of Commentary

Arabic

- Clear, readable Arabic Script ✦
- Equal to one page from the Mushaf ✦

Translation

- English based on modified Ali Quli Qara'i Translation ✦
- Structured to facilitate ease of reading in tandem with Arabic. ✦

وَلَن تَرْضَىٰ عَنكَ ٱلْيَهُودُ وَلَا ٱلنَّصَـٰرَىٰ حَتَّىٰ تَتَّبِعَ مِلَّتَهُمْ ۗ قُلْ إِنَّ هُدَى ٱللَّهِ هُوَ
ٱلْهُدَىٰ ۗ وَلَئِنِ ٱتَّبَعْتَ أَهْوَآءَهُم بَعْدَ ٱلَّذِى جَآءَكَ مِنَ ٱلْعِلْمِ ۙ مَا لَكَ مِنَ ٱللَّهِ مِن
وَلِىٍّ وَلَا نَصِيرٍ ﴿١٢٠﴾ ٱلَّذِينَ ءَاتَيْنَـٰهُمُ ٱلْكِتَـٰبَ يَتْلُونَهُۥ حَقَّ تِلَاوَتِهِۦٓ ۚ أُو۟لَـٰٓئِكَ يُؤْمِنُونَ
بِهِۦ ۗ وَمَن يَكْفُرْ بِهِۦ فَأُو۟لَـٰٓئِكَ هُمُ ٱلْخَـٰسِرُونَ ﴿١٢١﴾ يَـٰبَنِىٓ إِسْرَٰٓءِيلَ ٱذْكُرُوا۟ نِعْمَتِىَ ٱلَّتِىٓ
أَنْعَمْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ وَأَنِّى فَضَّلْتُكُمْ عَلَى ٱلْعَـٰلَمِينَ ﴿١٢٢﴾ وَٱتَّقُوا۟ يَوْمًا لَّا تَجْزِى نَفْسٌ
عَن نَّفْسٍ شَيْـًٔا وَلَا يُقْبَلُ مِنْهَا عَدْلٌ وَلَا تَنفَعُهَا شَفَـٰعَةٌ وَلَا هُمْ يُنصَرُونَ ﴿١٢٣﴾
وَإِذِ ٱبْتَلَىٰٓ إِبْرَٰهِـۧمَ رَبُّهُۥ بِكَلِمَـٰتٍ فَأَتَمَّهُنَّ ۖ قَالَ إِنِّى جَاعِلُكَ لِلنَّاسِ إِمَامًا ۖ قَالَ
وَمِن ذُرِّيَّتِى ۖ قَالَ لَا يَنَالُ عَهْدِى ٱلظَّـٰلِمِينَ ﴿١٢٤﴾ وَإِذْ جَعَلْنَا ٱلْبَيْتَ مَثَابَةً لِّلنَّاسِ
وَأَمْنًا وَٱتَّخِذُوا۟ مِن مَّقَامِ إِبْرَٰهِـۧمَ مُصَلًّى ۖ وَعَهِدْنَآ إِلَىٰٓ إِبْرَٰهِـۧمَ وَإِسْمَـٰعِيلَ أَن طَهِّرَا
بَيْتِىَ لِلطَّآئِفِينَ وَٱلْعَـٰكِفِينَ وَٱلرُّكَّعِ ٱلسُّجُودِ ﴿١٢٥﴾ وَإِذْ قَالَ إِبْرَٰهِـۧمُ رَبِّ ٱجْعَلْ
هَـٰذَا بَلَدًا ءَامِنًا وَٱرْزُقْ أَهْلَهُۥ مِنَ ٱلثَّمَرَٰتِ مَنْ ءَامَنَ مِنْهُم بِٱللَّهِ وَٱلْيَوْمِ ٱلْـَٔاخِرِ
ۖ قَالَ وَمَن كَفَرَ فَأُمَتِّعُهُۥ قَلِيلًا ثُمَّ أَضْطَرُّهُۥٓ إِلَىٰ عَذَابِ ٱلنَّارِ ۖ وَبِئْسَ ٱلْمَصِيرُ ﴿١٢٦﴾

2:120 Never will the Jews be pleased with you, nor the Christians, unless you followed their creed. Say, 'Indeed it is the guidance of Allah which is the [true] guidance.' And should you follow their desires after the knowledge that has come to you, you will not have against Allah any guardian nor any helper.

2:121 Those to whom We have given the Book follow it as it ought to be followed: they have faith in it. As for those who defy it—it is they who are the losers.

2:122 O Children of Israel, remember My blessing which I bestowed upon you, and that I gave you an advantage over all the nations.

2:123 And beware of the Day when no soul shall compensate for another, neither shall any ransom be accepted from it, nor shall any intercession benefit it, nor will they be helped.

2:124 And when his Lord tested Abraham with certain words, and he fulfilled them, He said, 'I am making you the Imam of mankind.' Said he, 'And from among my descendants?' He said, 'My pledge does not extend to the unjust.'

2:125 And [remember] when We made the House a place of reward for mankind and a sanctuary, [declaring], 'Take the venue of prayer from Abraham's Station.' We charged Abraham and Ishmael [with its upkeep, saying], 'Purify My House for those who go around it, [for] those who make it a retreat and [for] those who bow and prostrate.'

2:126 And when Abraham said, 'My Lord, make this a secure town, and provide its people with fruits—such of them as have faith in Allah and the Last Day,' He said, 'As for him who is faithless, I will provide for him [too] for a short time, then I will shove him toward the punishment of the Fire, and it is an evil destination.'

2:121 ﴿ Reading the Qur'an as it should be read With regards to the phrase, '*Those to whom We have given the 'Book read it as it ought to be read...*', Imam al-Ṣādiq ﷺ is narrated to have said: 'This means that the verses of the Qur'an should be read in a careful and measured fashion, their meanings should be understood, and their ordinances acted upon. Their rewards should be hoped for and their punishments feared. Their stories should have a lesson taken from them, their commands should be followed, and their prohibitions should be avoided. I swear by God that this verse does not simply mean that one should memorise the Qur'an's verses, learn how to recite its letters and chapters, or that its chapters are divided into ten or five groups. There are those who memorise the Qur'an's letters but forget its boundaries! No, the meaning of this verse is that you should ponder about the meaning of its verses and act on their commands!'[105]

2:124 ﴿ The Imamate of the Prophet Abraham ﷺ About the verse, '*And when his Lord tested Abraham with certain words*', commentators have said that God tested Abraham ﷺ with a variety of hardships and challenges: For example, by commanding him to leave behind his wife and child in a barren desert, the opposition of the idol worshippers toward him, commanding him to destroy the idols in their temple and his being thrown into a bonfire, his being forced to leave his homeland, and so on. In *Sūrat al-Ṣāffāt*, God says describes '*a manifest test*'[106], namely when He commanded Abraham to offer his son, Ishmael, as a sacrifice. Commentators on the Qur'an have said that this command was revealed to Abraham towards the end of his life and that, before he was made an Imam, he was already a prophet. This shows that the rank of Imamate is higher than that of prophethood. There is a tradition from Imam al-Sadiq ﷺ, which says: 'God chose Abraham as His servant before He chose him as His prophet. And God chose him as a prophet before He made him his messenger. And He made him a messenger before He selected him as His confidant (*khalil*). And He selected him as His confidant before He made him an Imam. It was only once Abraham had achieved all of these ranks that God told him: '*I am making you the Imam of mankind*.' Abraham realised the importance of this rank, so he implored God: '*And from among my descendants?*' (i.e. 'Will you make my descendants Imams as well?').' An Imam is someone who other people take as an example and follow in both speech and action. The task of a prophet is to deliver God's message and to show mankind the way to happiness. However, the task of an Imam is to apply God's laws and commandments. In other words, through the divine power given to him, the Imam provides a practical demonstration to people of how to walk the path of guidance and attain spiritual and moral perfection. The Imam doesn't just *point* people to the way, he *leads* them along it.[107] This verse is also one of the proofs for the infallibility of the Imams, as God explicitly says that His covenant of Imamate does not include any wrongdoers. In other words, any act of wrongdoing, injustice, or oppression – no matter where, how or by whom – would automatically preclude a person from holding the rank of Imamate.[108]

2:125 ﴿ 'And when We made the House a place of return for mankind and a sanctuary...' The Arabic word '*mathaba*' is derived from '*thawb*' meaning 'to return something to its original state.' The House of God is a place towards which monotheists throughout history have turned, not only in the physical sense of facing it in prayer, but in the spiritual sense also of turning back to divine unity (*tawhid*) and their original nature (*fitrah*). In this sense, the Kaaba is a *mathaba*, or 'place of return'. Meanwhile, the Station of Abraham (Maqām Ibrāhīm) is a location in the vicinity of the Kaaba, which pilgrims pass by as they perform the rite of circumambulation. According to one narration, the Station of Abraham is the place where Abraham actually stood and where his foot left an impression on a stone.[109]

[105] *Mīzān*, 1/262.
[106] Q37:106.
[107] See *Mīzān*, 1/262; *Nimūnah*, 1/436.
[108] *Tafsīr Mawḍū'ī*, 3/221.
[109] See *Nimūnah*, 1/447; *Atyab al-Bayān*, 2/187.

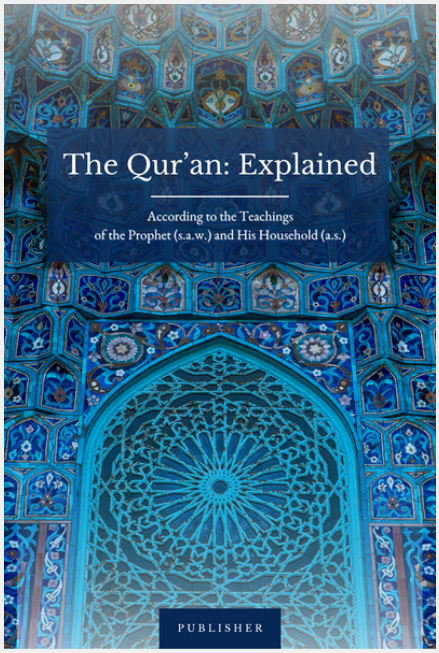
Commentary

- ✦ Deeper reflections extracted from the most authoritative Shi'i tafsirs
- ✦ Goes beyond surface meaning of verses to convey teachings of Ahlulbayt (a.s.)

References

- ✦ To allow readers to see source material and conduct further research

Commentary drawn from 30 Different Shi'i Tafsirs and Compilations



Tafsir al-Mizan
Allamah Tabataba'i

Majma' al-Bayan
Shaykh al-Tabrisi

Tafsir Nimuneh
Ayatullah Makarem Shirazi

Tafsir al-Safi
Fayd Kashani

Tafsir Ala' al-Rahman
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Sayyid Hashim al-Bahrani

Manshur-i Javid
Ayatullah Ja'far Sobhani

Atyab al-Bayan
Sayyid 'Abd al-Husayn Tayyib

The Team

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Principle Translator

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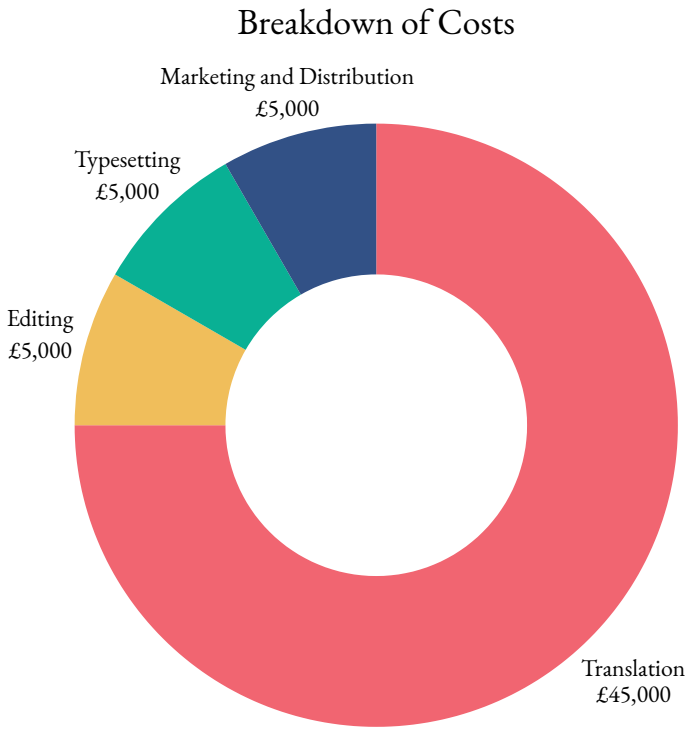
Publication Team:
Translators, Editors, Typesetters

Technical Team:
Experts in app development, data architecture, and digital marketing

Subject Matter Experts:
Scholars, Public speakers, Influencers

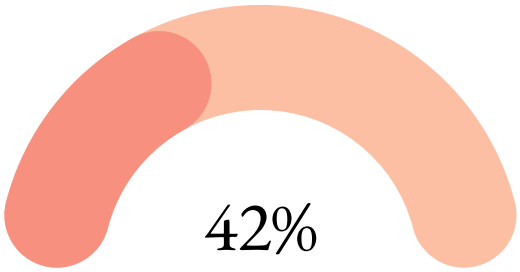
Funding Strategy



- Total project cost: £60,000 (see breakdown).
- Donations can be received by registered partner charity (https://compassionforhumanity.org.uk/):
  - Gift aid eligible.
  - Tax-deductible for businesses.
- All profits to be reinvested into:
  - Free distribution (mosques, prisons etc.)
  - Additional features (app, website).
  - Similar Projects.

Funds Raised

- Funds **raised** to date: £25,000
- Amount remaining to **fully fund** prohect: £35,000

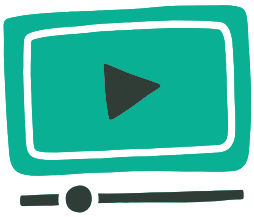


Project Status

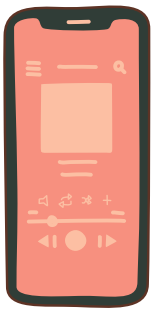
- 302/604 pages **completed.**
- Until **verse** 18:83
- Target for **Completion**: Sept 2026

Project Phases

Phase 1: ***The Qur'an Explained***
Deliver a complete one-volume commentary with a unique dual-page layout, publish in print and digital formats, with a website and mailing list for community engagement.

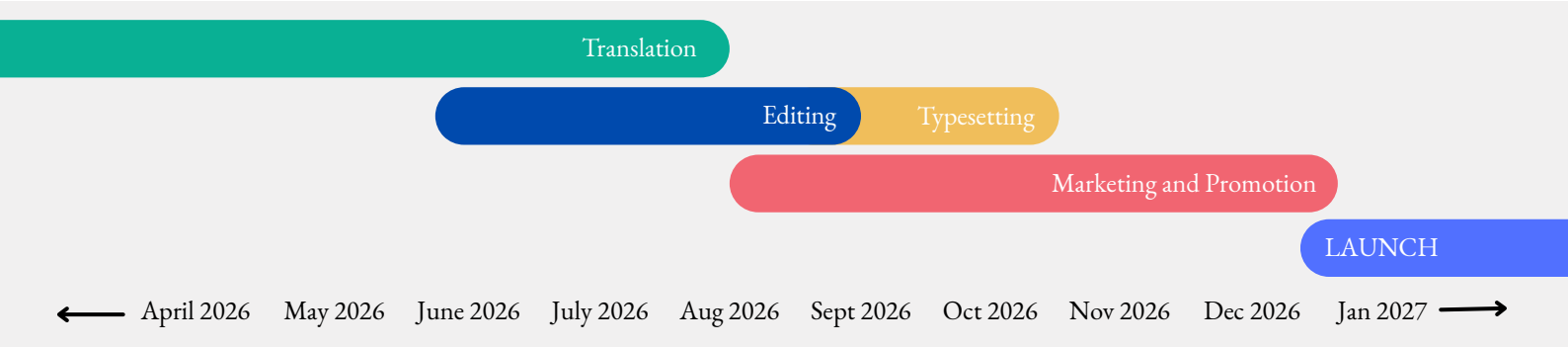


Phase 2: ***Daily Qur'an Challenge***
Create a guided **micro-learning** experience with an expanded website and email subscription flow. **Daily content** including Arabic recitation paired with English audio translation of the day's page and short audio explanatory notes.



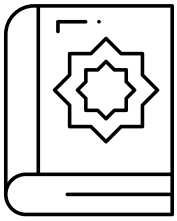
Phase 3: ***Daily Qur'an App***
A comprehensive learning platform: **Listen** to Arabic recitation + English audio translation; **Read** Arabic, translation, and pronunciation guide; **Access** explanatory notes (text + audio) inside the app. Infinitely expandable.

Phase 1 Timeline

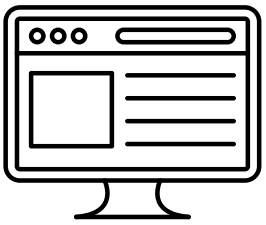


Why Support this project?

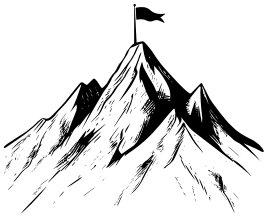
Sadaqa Jariya
High impact with **global** benefit



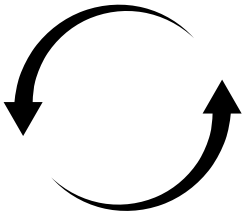
First of its Kind
Meeting a **critical** educational need.



Digital Ecosystem
Ensuring continuous **engagement**



Experienced team
With proven track record of **delivery**



Long-term sustainability
Revenue reinvested into widening **access**

How to Support

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